

Cabazon Editorial

Cabazon Embroiled in Political Turmoil

CABAZON —Political turmoil continues in this city of some 900 persons where two gambling casinos stand between a city government with a slim budget and one with none.

Continual controversy, usually involving clashing personalities among the city councilmen, takes its toll of a mayor a year if not more often.

The latest switch occurred with three of the city councilmen teaming with the three city employees to oust Thomas DeLuca as mayor. The employees, a city clerk and a building inspector who live in Banning and a police chief who lives in Beaumont, submitted letters of resignation if "the dictator tactics" of DeLuca were not ended.

By 3-2 votes, the three city councilmen

—Lawrence Linnebach, William Thompson and Thomas Reynolds — vacated DeLuca's position and named Linnebach mayor.

Linnebach, on evidence furnished by DeLuca, was then arrested on two counts of contracting without a license charged by a state license investigator. He has entered an innocent plea and his jury trial has been set in the San Geronimo Justice Court for January.

Meantime, the Cabazon Citizens Committee for Better Government raised

funds through a box social to launch a recall action against Mayor Linnebach and Councilmen Thompson and Reynolds.

DeLuca also has charged Linnebach, Thompson and Reynolds with "conflicts of interest" and has turned evidence against them over to the Riverside County district attorney's office.

DeLuca and his backers claim that despite receiving \$25,000 from El Cid, the new casino, for the first year license

fee, the city already is operating on a deficit budget.

Next year, the budget will suffer a \$12,500 drop with both gambling casinos then paying the annual license fee after the first year of \$12,500.

So long as the political climate remains as it has during a nine-year history of incorporation, the only advances seen for the community will be from the clean-up of one City Hall regime to the clean-up of the next.

Urban Renewal Program Threat

City Manager Says Slum Area Must

Clipped By:

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